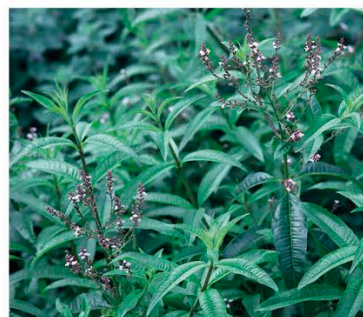




Plants for herb gardens

Culinary and medicinal herbs have been grown for centuries and many modern herb gardens still reflect medieval and Renaissance designs.

You can opt for a traditional style and dedicate small, rectangular beds to individual plants, or try combining herbs with ornamentals in a mixed bed. Low-growing herbs, such as thyme, also make a great edging for a border. Many compact herbs are suitable for containers, but restrict rampant growers, such as mint and lemon balm, to a pot of their own. Shrubby herbs, including rosemary and sage, will develop into substantial plants and are best grown in the ground in the long term and pruned each spring before bud break to encourage new growth.



SHRUB LARGE

Lemon verbena

Aloysia triphylla This spreading shrub has lance-shaped leaves that smell and taste of lemon. Spikes of small white flowers appear in summer. Infuse the leaves in water to make a soothing tea, and use them to flavor sweet dishes.

±10ft (3m)

☞ Z8–11

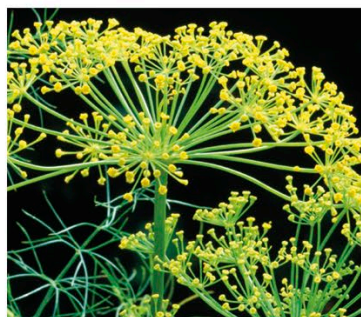


ANNUAL/BIENNIAL SMALL

Chervil

Anthriscus cerefolium A biennial member of the parsley family, it has anise-flavoured fernlike green foliage and flat clusters of tiny white flowers in summer. Use the leaves in salads and other dishes.

±20in (50cm) ↔ 10in (24cm)



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL LARGE

Dill

Anethum graveolens A tall upright annual with aromatic, fernlike gray-green leaves and rounded clusters of gold-green summer flowers followed by edible seeds. Use the leaves to flavor fish and poultry dishes; readily reseeds in gardens.

±4ft (1.2m) ↔ 24in (60cm)

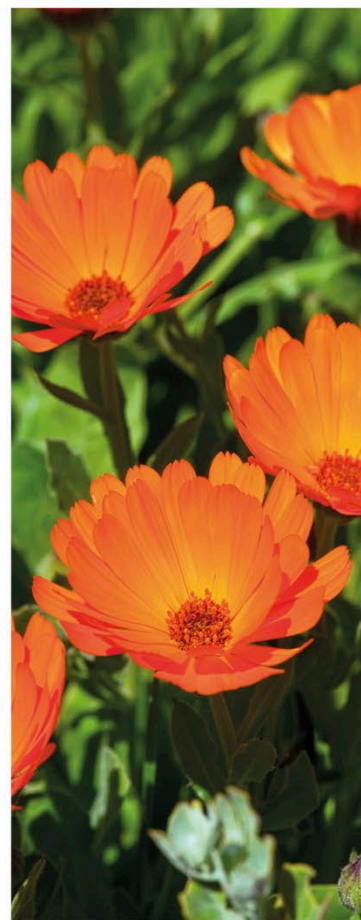


ANNUAL/BIENNIAL LARGE

Angelica

Angelica archangelica A tall biennial that produces decorative, deeply cut green leaves and domed heads of tiny green flowers in summer. The leaves are used for tea infusions, and tender young stems can be candied. It self-seeds freely.

±6ft (2m) ↔ 3ft (1m)

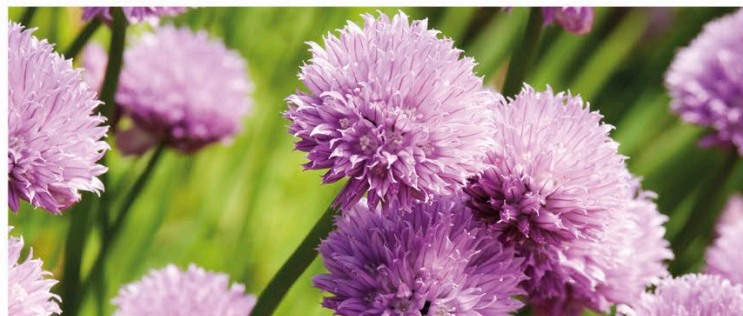


ANNUAL/BIENNIAL MEDIUM

Pot marigold

Calendula officinalis This annual has aromatic green leaves. From spring to fall, daisy-like flowers in shades of yellow and orange appear. The young leaves can be added to salads, and the flowers used as a garnish.

±24in (60cm)



BULB MEDIUM

Chives

Allium schoenoprasum This spring-flowering perennial bulb has hollow, dark green grassy leaves and pale purple or pink pom-pom flowers. Use the mild onion-flavored leaves in salads and other dishes and flowers for vinegars.

±12in (30cm)

☞ Z4–8



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL MEDIUM

Borage

Borago officinalis An upright annual with cucumber-flavored aromatic, oval green leaves that are added to salads or summer drinks. The small, star-shaped, blue edible flowers in summer can be used as garnish. Leave spent blooms to allow self-seeding.

±3ft (1m) ↔ 12in (30cm)



PERENNIAL LARGE

French tarragon

***Artemisia dracunculus* 'Sativa'**

An upright perennial with aromatic, linear green leaves on wiry stems. Grow in a sheltered area or in a container; it can be short-lived. Use its peppery leaves in salads or to flavor chicken and egg dishes.

±up to 3ft (1m) ↔ 12in (30cm)

☞ Z3–7 (N)